

Nests can contain more than **300,000** ants.

Ants' nests have to stay at the right temperature for their babies to survive.

So ants line their nests with grass and pine needles to keep them warm.

Wood ants sunbathe outside their nest. It helps warm their home when they return.

When baby ants (larvae) grow big enough, they wrap up in silken cocoons.

Almost all of the ants in the nest are female workers. They take care of the baby ants.

Workers bring food to their queen.

Ant royalty

Some wood ant nests have only one queen, but sometimes they join together to form huge nests with many queens. The queen's only role is to lay eggs.

Queen ant

Eggs